ENGLISH B2 · EXERCISE WORKBOOK

Past perfect continuous

Printable practice for Past perfect continuous in English B2. No explanations or solutions interrupt the work pages.

THIS DOCUMENT

Exercise workbook

30 learning decisions arranged in six progressive stages. Write directly on the page and consult the separate answer key only after completing a stage.

RECOMMENDED USE

Keep the three-document system together

Use the complete guide to understand the concept, this workbook to practise, and the answer key to diagnose each decision.

WELEARN STUDY SEQUENCE

01	02	03	04
complete guide	exercise workbook	answer key	retrieval review

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an ongoing activity measured up to a past event?

OPTIONS They had been testing the system for hours before it failed. · Her hands were covered in paint because she had been decorating. · I had been preparing the report when the priorities changed.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an earlier activity inferred from a past result?

OPTIONS Her hands were covered in paint because she had been decorating. · I had been preparing the report when the priorities changed. · They had been testing the system for hours before it failed.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an extended earlier process interrupted by a later decision?

OPTIONS I had been preparing the report when the priorities changed. · They had been testing the system for hours before it failed. · Her hands were covered in paint because she had been decorating.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “They had been testing the system for hours before it failed.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an ongoing activity measured up to a past event · an earlier activity inferred from a past result · an extended earlier process interrupted by a later decision

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “Her hands were covered in paint because she had been decorating.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an earlier activity inferred from a past result · an extended earlier process interrupted by a later decision · an ongoing activity measured up to a past event

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “I had been preparing the report when the priorities changed.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an extended earlier process interrupted by a later decision · an ongoing activity measured up to a past event · an earlier activity inferred from a past result

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

"They had been testing the system for hours before it failed." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Duration before past / Past evidence / Interrupted process · Gap 2: an ongoing activity measured up to a past event / an earlier activity inferred from a past result / an extended earlier process interrupted by a later decision

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

"Her hands were covered in paint because she had been decorating." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Past evidence / Interrupted process / Duration before past · Gap 2: an earlier activity inferred from a past result / an extended earlier process interrupted by a later decision / an ongoing activity measured up to a past event

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

"I had been preparing the report when the priorities changed." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Interrupted process / Duration before past / Past evidence · Gap 2: an extended earlier process interrupted by a later decision / an ongoing activity measured up to a past event / an earlier activity inferred from a past result

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses an ongoing activity measured up to a past event: _____. Choose the model that expresses an earlier activity inferred from a past result: _____. Choose the model that expresses an extended earlier process interrupted by a later decision: _____. Choose the model built with had been + -ing + for/since: _____. Choose the model built with had been + -ing: _____. Choose the model built with had been + -ing + when: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

Her hands were covered in paint because she had been decorating. · I had been preparing the report when the priorities changed. · They had been testing the system for hours before it failed.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

They _____ the system for hours before it failed. Her hands were covered in paint because she _____. I _____ the report when the priorities changed. State the full structural pattern for Duration before past: _____. State the full structural pattern for Past evidence: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “Testing continued for hours and then the system failed.” using the Duration before past pattern to express an ongoing activity measured up to a past event.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “The paint on her hands showed what she had been doing.” using the Past evidence pattern to express an earlier activity inferred from a past result.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “Preparation was in progress until the priorities changed.” using the Interrupted process pattern to express an extended earlier process interrupted by a later decision.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “Testing continued for hours and then the system failed.” using the Duration before past pattern to express an ongoing activity measured up to a past event.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Duration before past to express an ongoing activity measured up to a past event, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Past evidence to express an earlier activity inferred from a past result, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Interrupted process to express an extended earlier process interrupted by a later decision, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

07 · RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____